

Meserete Haimanot Sunday School Website

Product Requirements & Software Requirements Specification (PRD/SRS)

Project: Website Development for Meserete Haimanot Sunday School, Ta'eka Negest Bete Le Mariam Gedam (EOTC) **Prepared from:** Group 26 research (Problem Statement, Literature Review, Methodology, Survey/Questionnaire Analysis, Conclusions & Recommendations) **Document version:** 1.0

1. Purpose & Background

Meserete Haimanot Sunday School currently has **no official website**. All communication, teaching material distribution, and administrative work happens through **fragmented channels** — mainly Telegram, Facebook, YouTube, paper handouts, and word of mouth.

A 13-respondent survey of students, teachers, choir members, administrators, and congregation members confirmed this is a real and urgent problem, not a "nice-to-have":

- **76.9%** said having a dedicated website is "very important."
- **92.3%** said they would use it regularly once built.
- **100%** said mobile-friendliness is essential.
- **46.2%** currently experience clear gaps in how information reaches them.

The website is meant to be a **strategic solution**, not a decorative add-on — solving three concrete problems: scattered information, limited access to educational content, and no structured way to collect online donations.

2. Problem Statement (from research)

#	Problem	Description
1	Data centralization gap	No central digital archive for the school's history, magazines, research papers, teachings, and hymns. Content is at risk of being lost or becoming hard to find.

#	Problem	Description
2	Limited educational reach	Weekly classes, courses, and sermons only reach people who attend in person. No e-learning option for diaspora members or those who can't attend physically.
3	Communication barrier	Event/program announcements only go out via paper flyers or social media, which are easily buried by algorithms and aren't organized like a proper archive.
4	Resource mobilization limit	No safe, trustworthy online channel for local and diaspora donors to learn about the school's needs and contribute funds securely.

Additional gaps found in the survey: - Teachers currently distribute **handouts** via Telegram or paper — students report low readability and difficulty accessing them. - **44.4%** of respondents believe there's no dedicated team/person currently responsible for keeping content updated. - Main complaints about the current system: delayed information, missed posts, poor organization.

3. Goals & Objectives

3.1 General Objective

Deliver a website that closes the digital divide between the Sunday School and its members (especially youth and diaspora) by centralizing information, education, and community engagement.

3.2 Specific Objectives

1. Identify and resolve the scope of communication/access problems.
2. Provide a **digital archive** for historical documents, teachings, and hymns.
3. Meet the actual expressed needs of members and congregation (e-learning, donations, news).
4. Provide a concrete website structure/feature list to guide development (this document).

4. Target Users / Personas

Persona	% of survey sample	Primary needs
Students	46.2%	Download handouts/notes, view class materials, ask questions

Persona	% of survey sample	Primary needs
Administration / Staff	23.1%	Publish announcements, manage registrations, manage member records, view reports
Choir / Ministry members	23.1%	Access hymn/lesson archive, event schedules
General Congregation / Diaspora	7.7% (but broader in scope)	Follow news and programs remotely, donate online, read spiritual articles

Age skew: mostly **26-40 years old (69.2%)** — a tech-comfortable, mobile-first demographic. Design should not assume a purely older or purely young audience, but **mobile-first is non-negotiable** (100% requirement).

5. Scope

In scope: A public website for Meserete Haimanot Sunday School specifically (not a general EOTC Sunday School platform), covering informational content, educational content delivery, a discussion forum, member/administrative tools, and online donations.

Out of scope (for v1): Replacing social media entirely (Telegram/Facebook/YouTube will continue to run in parallel and can feed into or link from the site), building a native mobile app (a mobile-responsive website is the requirement, not an app).

6. Functional Requirements (Features)

6.1 Public / Informational Module

- Home page with mission, church identity, and branding.
- **History page** — story of the Sunday School and of the website itself.
- News & announcements feed (replacing scattered social media posts).
- Event/program calendar (services, holidays, special programs).
- Photo and video gallery / multimedia archive.
- Spiritual articles, saints' biographies, and devotional writings.

6.2 Educational Module (E-Learning)

- **Digital Archive** for teaching materials organized by class/grade.

- Downloadable handouts and lesson notes (solves the "students can't get notes" complaint).
- Audio/video lesson library (recorded sermons, taught lessons).
- Hymn (mezmur) archive with lyrics and/or audio files.
- Support for remote/diaspora learners to access lessons asynchronously.

6.3 Community & Engagement Module

- **Discussion forum** (92.3% support) for theological, ethical, and doctrinal Q&A between students/teachers, moderated to ensure answers are Orthodox-doctrine-aligned.
- Youth program listings/updates.
- Comment or Q&A capability tied to lessons (optional, if forum covers this).

6.4 Administrative Module

- **Online registration** for new students/members (100% of respondents want this — replaces manual/paper sign-up).
- Member database / directory for admin use.
- Member management & reporting tools (77.8–77% of respondents want this) — attendance, participation tracking, reports for leadership.
- Content management system (CMS) so a designated "Digital Media & Information" team/person can publish updates without developer help — this directly addresses the 44.4% concern about no update process existing.
- Admin dashboard for managing announcements, registrations, and content.

6.5 Finance / Donation Module

- **Online donation / contribution collection** integrated with local payment options (e.g., Telebirr, bank transfer) — 70% of respondents want this.
- Should support both local and diaspora (international) donors, since one stated goal is letting distant supporters contribute "without any distance limitation."
- Secure, trustworthy transaction handling (this was explicitly flagged as currently missing/unsafe).

7. Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Detail
Mobile responsiveness	Mandatory — 100% of respondents require a mobile-friendly experience. Should be designed mobile-first , not adapted afterward.
Usability	

Requirement	Detail
	Simple navigation; must work for a wide age range (under 18 to 41+).
Content freshness	Needs a defined content-update workflow/owner (daily or weekly cadence), not just a static build.
Security	Especially around donation/payment data and member records.
Accessibility for remote/diaspora users	No login/geography barriers for viewing educational and event content.
Maintainability	CMS-driven content areas so non-developers can update news, events, and materials.

8. Technical Stack (Recommended)

The original research (Chapter 3 Methodology) proposed an HTML/CSS/JS + PHP + MySQL + XAMPP stack. That reflects a typical academic-project setup, but it isn't the best fit for a site that needs ongoing content updates, a member database, a forum, and payment integration, maintained by a small/volunteer team. The recommended stack below satisfies the same functional requirements with a simpler, more maintainable setup.

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Frontend	Next.js (React) + Tailwind CSS	One framework for both public pages and interactive features (forum, registration forms). Tailwind makes mobile-first styling fast — important since 100% of survey respondents require mobile-friendliness.
Backend	Node.js, via Next.js API routes	No separate backend service needed — backend logic lives in the same project and language (JavaScript/TypeScript) as the frontend. Simpler for a small team to build and maintain than running two separate codebases. Also a natural fit for handling payment webhooks (Telebirr/bank integration) server-side.
Database	PostgreSQL, with Prisma as the ORM	Reliable, well-supported relational database. Prisma pairs cleanly with Postgres and Next.js and makes the member database, registration, and reporting features straightforward to build.

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Local dev environment	Node.js + npm/pnpm, Docker (for running Postgres locally), VS Code	Docker removes the need for each contributor to manually install/configure Postgres.
Hosting (suggested)	Vercel (app) + a managed Postgres provider such as Neon or Supabase	Both offer generous free tiers, which matters for a church-run project without dedicated infrastructure budget.
Development model	Iterative (build/test in small feature slices) rather than strict Waterfall	Better suited to a small team validating features (like the forum or payment flow) against real user feedback as they go.

Alternative worth considering: Django (Python) is also a solid fit, mainly because its built-in admin panel provides much of the "content management" and "member management" functionality out of the box. The tradeoff is that it's a separate language/ecosystem from the frontend. Next.js is recommended as the primary path for a smaller or volunteer-driven team; Django remains a reasonable alternative if the available developers are more Python-comfortable.

Minimum hardware/software baseline for local development: a computer/laptop with at least 4GB RAM (8GB recommended for running Docker comfortably), internet access, and a modern browser.

9. Key Survey Data Reference (for prioritization)

Metric	Result
Website is "very important"	76.9%
Will use website regularly once built	92.3%
Want mobile-friendly design	100%
Want online registration	100%
Want forum/discussion feature	92.3%
Want online donation collection	70%
Currently face info-delivery gaps	46.2%
Currently get info only "sometimes"	53.8%
Never get the info they need	15.4%

Metric	Result
Want member management/reporting	77.8%
No dedicated content-update team exists yet	44.4%
Primary current info channel	Social media (Telegram/Facebook/YouTube) – 84.6%

Takeaway for prioritization: Registration, mobile responsiveness, and the educational archive/download feature are near-universal demands (100%) and should be treated as **must-have for v1**. The forum and donation features are close behind (92.3% / 70%) and should also be in v1 if scope allows, or fast-follow.

10. Risks / Constraints Noted in Research

- No dedicated staff/media team currently exists to keep content updated — **this is an operational risk, not just a technical one**. Recommend defining a "Digital Media & Information" role/team before or alongside launch.
- Original study had a 2-month time constraint and limited prior local data to benchmark against — meaning some requirements are based on a small (13-person) sample and should be validated with a larger user base post-launch.

11. Recommended v1 Feature Priority (suggested grouping)

Must-have (launch blockers): 1. Mobile-responsive public site (home, history, news, events) 2. Online registration 3. Educational material download/archive 4. Basic CMS for admin to post updates

Should-have (fast-follow): 5. Discussion forum 6. Online donation integration 7. Member management/reporting dashboard

Nice-to-have (later phase): 8. Video/audio lesson streaming library 9. Expanded spiritual articles/saints' history section 10. Youth program microsite/section

This document consolidates the Problem Statement, Literature Review, Chapter 3 Methodology, Survey/Questionnaire Analysis, and Conclusions/Recommendations chapters submitted for this project. Use it as the baseline brief for wireframing and technical architecture decisions.